

Simtec Consult - Backup and Business Continuity Policy

Version: 1.0

Status: Approved

Owner: Director

Applies to: business systems, source code, customer applications, recovery processes

Related to: Cyber Essentials

Last reviewed: 2026-06-03

Next review due: 2026-09-03

Purpose

Simtec must be able to recover from cyber incidents, supplier outages, device loss, accidental deletion, and operational disruption.

Policy

Recovery work should prioritise safety and legal obligations, customer systems with contractual or production impact, identity and email, source control and deployment access, finance and business administration systems, and lower-impact internal services.

Backups or equivalent recovery options must be considered for customer application data hosted by Simtec, important company documents, source code and repository configuration, deployment and infrastructure configuration, business-critical SaaS data where export or recovery is available, and password manager recovery arrangements.

Not every system requires a separate backup if the supplier provides suitable resilience and recovery, but the recovery approach must be understood.

Backups must be protected from unauthorised access, use MFA where supported, be stored separately from the primary system where practical, avoid reliance on a single device, use encryption where available, be retained only as long as needed, and be deleted securely when no longer required.

Removable backup media must not be left connected when not in use.

Material backups or recovery processes must be reviewed or tested at least annually and after material changes. Testing may include restoring a file, confirming repository access and branch history, testing database restore to a safe environment, checking supplier export, or reviewing recovery steps.

If ransomware or destructive activity is suspected, do not overwrite known-good backups. Preserve evidence where safe, isolate affected systems, rotate credentials from a clean device, confirm backup integrity before restore, and rebuild compromised systems where appropriate.

Review

Backup and continuity arrangements are reviewed at least annually, after material hosting changes, and after significant incidents or restore failures.

Review History

Date	Reviewer	Description	Next review due
2026-06-03	Policy Manager	Created current policy document aligned to Simtec requirements and relevant Cyber Essentials answers.	2026-09-03